



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Sally goes back home for a visit.



Learning Outcome

Describe rooms, homes and objects in buildings in common social and work situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can use and say words with the silent e.
- I can identify key information in a short audio.
- I can pronounce weak form.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you visit your family?
- Did your family keep things from when you were a child?





Let's Explore!

Listen to Sally and her Mom **reminisce*** about the past.

* To "*reminisce*" means to talk, think, or write about things that happened in the past.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Sally's Mom: You must be happy to be back after such a long flight.

Sally: Yes, my bedroom brings back so many memories! Oh my old stuffed animals. I still love them.

Sally's Mom: There are at least five more in the closet.

Sally: Pugsly, my stuffed dog. He's so cute.

Sally's Mom: Yes, I kept your toys and posters.

Sally: Oh Mom, that's sweet. You even kept my old unicorn comforter with the rainbows!

Sally's Mom: Honey, I'll never throw anything of yours out.

Sally: Nothing?

Sally's Mom: Well, there were some old clothes from your teenage years.

Sally: Oh my goth phase ... the black clothes and lipstick.

Sally's Mom: Don't you love all the old photographs of your friends too?

Sally: Yes, and look at this note I wrote to my penpal in South Africa.

Sally's Mom: What was her name again?

Sally: Rita de Boer. She used to send me little presents too!

Sally's Mom: What are you doing?

Sally: Could I take Pugsly back with me to my apartment as a little memento?

Sally's Mom: Sure. I hope that cat of yours, Meeneee, doesn't get too upset.





Let's Practice!

Sh ... the e is silent!

Instructions: Practice reading the words and sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. cute
2. phase
3. note
4. five
5. Yes, and look at this note I wrote to my penpal in South Africa.
6. Oh my goth phase ... the black clothes and lipstick.
7. There are at least five more in the closet.
8. He's so cute.



Let's Practice!

Do you remember how to pronounce the less important words* in a sentence?

*Weak forms occur on small, "less important words" that link the operative, key content words of a sentence together.

Instructions: Select the words in the sentences that are the weak forms.

1. There are at least five more in the closet.
2. Yes, I kept your toys and posters.
3. What was her name again?





Extension Activity

Do you keep mementos from the past? What are they and why are they important to you?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Make a list of 10 objects you have from your childhood.
- Choose 5 things and write a sentence for each.
- With a partner, explain why you still have these items. Why are they important to you?

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I make a list of important items from my past.

☐ ☐

I write 5 sentences about these items.

☐ ☐

I explain why I still have them to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **stuffed animal** (noun): a toy in the shape of an animal that usually has fake fur and is filled with soft material
e.g. I love my old stuffed animals.
- **closet** (noun): a small room that is used for storing things
e.g. There are a lot of old clothes in my closet.
- **poster** (noun): a large picture that is put on walls as a decoration
e.g. I kept your toys and posters.
- **memento** (noun): something that is kept as a reminder of a person, place, or thing
e.g. I'll take Pugsly back to my apartment as a little memento.
- **comforter** (noun): a thick bed covering that is filled with a soft light material
e.g. You even kept my old unicorn comforter with the rainbows.
- **goth** (adjective): a person who listens to or performs goth music, wears mostly black clothing, uses black and white makeup, and often has dyed black hair
e.g. I was in my goth phase.
- **phase** (noun): a short period of time during which a person behaves in a particular way or likes a particular thing
e.g. That was a challenging phase in my life.
- **unicorn** (noun): an imaginary animal that looks like a horse and has a straight horn growing from the middle of its forehead
e.g. I have a unicorn comforter from my childhood.





Learning Points

One syllable Words With Silent e

There are 5 spelling rules for the silent e.

Rules	Example
1. A final e makes the vowel say its name.	<i>cut</i> <i>cute</i>
2. English words don't end in <i>v</i> or <i>u</i> . The e after <i>v</i> or <i>u</i> does not affect pronunciation.	<i>have</i> <i>blue</i>
3. Silent e after the letter <i>c</i> and <i>g</i> "soften" their sounds.	<i>rage</i> <i>cabbage</i> <i>face</i> <i>experience</i>
4. Every syllable must have a vowel. The final syllable can be pronounced without a vowel but every syllable must have a vowel.	<i>tackle</i> <i>pickle</i>
5. Sometimes the silent final e has no purpose.	<i>are</i> <i>were</i>

Weak Forms

Weak forms happen on small, less important words that link the operative, key **content words** of a sentence together.

Less Important Words	Examples: <i>am, are, be, been, can, could, do, does, has, was</i>
Prepositions	<i>at, for, from, of, to</i>
Pronouns	<i>he, her, him, his, me, she, them, us, we, you, your</i>
Verbs	<i>am, is, was</i>
Conjunctions	<i>and, but, or, than, that</i>
Articles	<i>a, the, an</i>

